Creative audit of kit v1.0 (before the reset)

This audit is based on rendered contact sheets of the actual files (`before/`), not on source code. It is deliberately blunt. The question for every element: *would anyone notice if this were moved, unchanged, onto a random hotel, airline or tourism start-up?*

Verdict

The kit is technically complete but creatively generic. It has the correct logo, a reasonable palette and working files. But most of the visual language around the logo is stock "AI travel brand" vocabulary. Rolling green hills with a sun, concentric rings, gold swooshes, contour patterns, pill buttons and a "luxury serif + Inter" pairing could belong to any tourism brand anywhere. The supplied logo is the only truly specific thing in the system, and the system does not use its drawing at all; it replaces it with generic substitutes.

The most damaging recurring problems (ranked)

#	Problem	Where it appears	Why it is damaging
1	**Generic layered "hills + dome + sun" landscapes** that are procedurally generated, unrelated to the logo's actual inselberg drawing	Backgrounds 05/06/09/11/14, all image placeholders, report cover, OG image, website hero, invitation, roll-up, presentation covers, mockups, intro film	This is the single most "AI-generated" signal in the kit. It competes with, and dilutes, the real mountain in the logo.
2	**Illustrated placeholders presented in the place of photography**	Every photo slot: templates, social, slides, web cards, mockups	Synthetic images where Nigeria should be shown. A tourism brand without real places looks like a template.
3	**Concentric "sun rings" / radiating circles**	Investment background, stage screen, NTW social, KPI slides, programme cover, motion C and D, guidelines cover	A sci-fi or tech cliché with no meaning for this brand.
4	**Gold + ivory tapered "horizon ribbons" / swooshes** along bottom edges	Stage screen, certificate, ceremonial letterhead, social, closing slides, intro end card	A generic swoosh. It loosely imitates the logo's swashes but is redrawn, so it is neither the logo nor a meaningful new idea.
5	**Decorative pattern library**: contour lines, sine "confluence" waves, dot grids	Patterns, backgrounds 07/08/13, map overlays, motion D	Texture used to fill space. The "Niger–Benue confluence" rationale was written after the fact.

#	Problem	Where it appears	Why it is damaging
6	**Typography: Playfair Display + Inter**	Everywhere	This is the default "elegant serif + neutral sans" pairing of generated branding. Playfair has no ₦ glyph and no tabular figures, so it is unsuitable for an investment brand. Display sizes are often large for drama rather than hierarchy.
7	**Over-tracked uppercase overlines (+0.22 em) on almost every block**, gold full stops after words, the campaign line forced in everywhere	Social, slides, documents, web, events	Turns every layout into the same formula and makes the proposition wallpaper.
8	**One composition reused at every size**: logo top-left, overline, big serif headline, gold pill CTA, swoosh at the bottom	Social (all 8 families), slides, events	It is a template, not a system. No editorial range.
9	**Rounded cards, pill buttons, pill tags, soft shadows**	Web components, social CTAs, investment cards	Generic SaaS/UI aesthetic, not institutional or editorial.
10	**Unconvincing mockups**: CSS rectangles posing as laptops, phones, lanyards and stages	15_MOCKUPS (12 scenes)	They read as fake and undermine credibility. Better to present artwork honestly or on real photography.
11	**Seals, badges and the roundel used as ornament**	Campaign seal, partner badge, stage, NTW, avatars	The circular-text seal is a cliché and edges towards an "official seal". The roundel is over-used outside its job (avatar and favicon).
12	**Gradients and glows**: radial "glow" behind every dark layout, golden-sky gradients, bloom on the sun, grain, vignette	Backgrounds, motion A/C/D, intro film	Effects used to compensate for weak composition.
13	**Motion clichés**: sun bloom, radiating rings, ribbon wipes, iris transitions, floating embers, a growth line with nodes, UI cards popping in	Motion A, C, D and the 25 s intro	Stock-template reveal grammar.
14	**Redundant logo variants**: a stacked lockup that repeats the primary, the landscape symbol with no clear job, and three roundel colourways	02	File count over use case.
15	**Too many colours**: 15 swatches, including invented "Laterite", "Savannah" and "Confluence Blue" accents	Charts, social, documents	Fragments the identity. The logo itself uses three colours.
16	**Document details**: tinted table headers on every table, a coloured call-out box on every page, a full-bleed generic landscape on the report cover, a chapter divider with a forest gradient, a certificate swoosh	09	Templates look decorated rather than designed for long-form reading.
17	**Icon family**: technically consistent, but generic (leaf, calendar, bus, bell, mic)	04/icons	Acceptable as a utility set, but it shouldn't be presented as brand language.

What is genuinely strong and must be preserved

- **The supplied logo**: its inselberg and sun, the swashes, the high-contrast serif wordmark with the river-like tail of the “D”, and the spaced NIGERIA. Geometry is preserved exactly, and the i-dot correction stands.
- **The core palette sampled from the logo**: Forest `#103428`, Ridge `#2C5040`, Sun Gold `#E8A432`.
- **Technical infrastructure**: single source of truth, vector logo masters (SVG/PDF/EPS), Word content controls, a real PPTX master, the motion renderer, the original synthesised audio and the QA script.
- **The illustrated characters in the intro film** were explicitly requested and are carefully built. Keep them, but remove the cliché transitions and effects around them.

Inconsistencies and technical findings

- Documents use Playfair/Inter while some web and social files depend on Google Fonts; the Office fallback (Georgia/Calibri) changes the look considerably.
- Background raster exports are correct. Their SVG sources contain feTurbulence filters (grain), which Illustrator and Figma don’t reproduce, so the "editable" source differs from the export.
- Placeholder images were clearly labelled, so nothing was misrepresented, but they look synthetic.
- No raster images are embedded in logo SVGs (verified by QA). The logo vector files are clean.

Direction for the reset (summary; see `DN_Creative-Direction_v2.md`)

1. **Use the logo’s own drawing**, not substitutes. The landscape artwork becomes a single, monumental, cropped "plate". No more procedural hills.
2. **Photography leads** wherever a place, person or food is meant. It is sourced from credible, licensed, Nigeria-specific stock and recorded. Illustration is never used as a stand-in for photography.
3. **An editorial typographic system** with real numerals and the Naira sign.
4. **Fewer, purposeful assets**: 8 backgrounds, 6–8 slide types done properly, a reduced logo set.
5. **Remove** rings, ribbons, pattern wallpaper, glows, pills, seals, fake mockups and gold dots outside the campaign lockup.